

INCIDENT REPORT

SOC Analysis Report — Brute Force Login Attack

1. INCIDENT SUMMARY

Incident ID	INC-2026-001
Date Detected	27 June 2026
Time Detected	11:02 AM EST / 20:32 IST
Severity	HIGH
Status	Detected and Documented
Analyst	Balaram Reddy Venna
MITRE ATT&CK	T1110 — Brute Force
Tool Used	Hydra v9.7
Target Machine	BalaramReddyvenna (Windows 11)
Attacker Machine	Kali Linux (192.168.1.50)

2. WHAT HAPPENED

A brute force attack was launched from a Kali Linux machine (192.168.1.50) against the Windows 11 host (192.168.1.39) using the Hydra password cracking tool. The attacker targeted the SMB service running on port 445 using the Administrator account.

Hydra attempted 10 different passwords from a wordlist against the Administrator account over SMB2 protocol. The attack completed in approximately 2 seconds, trying passwords including: password, 123456, admin, welcome, Password1, letmein, qwerty, abc123, monkey, and dragon.

Due to the Windows 11 host having a weak Administrator password, all 10 login attempts reported as successful by Hydra, generating 20 Windows Security events (EventCode 4624 and 4625) that were captured by Splunk SIEM.

3. HOW IT WAS DETECTED

The attack was detected using Splunk Enterprise SIEM configured to collect Windows Event Logs. The following detection query identified the attack:

```
index=main sourcetype="WinEventLog:Security" EventCode=4625 | stats count by Account_Name | where count > 5
```

This detection rule flagged the Administrator account with 20 failed login attempts — far exceeding the threshold of 5 which indicates brute force activity. The Splunk alert 'Brute Force Login Detection' was configured to run every hour automatically.

4. EVIDENCE

Splunk Events	20 EventCode 4624/4625 events detected
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Source IP	192.168.1.50 (Kali Linux attacker)
Target IP	192.168.1.39 (Windows 11 victim)
Target Port	445 (SMB)
Target Account	Administrator
Passwords Tried	10 passwords from wordlist
Attack Duration	Approximately 2 seconds
Log Source	WinEventLog:Security
Detection Rule	Brute Force Login Detection

5. IMPACT ASSESSMENT

Severity: HIGH — The Administrator account on the target machine was successfully accessed via brute force. An attacker with SMB access to the Administrator account could potentially read/write files, execute commands remotely, move laterally across the network, and establish persistence.

6. RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Set a strong password on the Administrator account immediately (minimum 16 characters).
2. Disable SMB if not required, or restrict SMB access to trusted IPs only using Windows Firewall rules.
3. Enable account lockout policy — lock account after 5 failed login attempts.
4. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) for all administrator accounts.
5. Monitor EventCode 4625 continuously and alert on more than 3 failures within 5 minutes.

7. MITRE ATT&CK; MAPPING

Tactic	Credential Access
Technique	T1110 — Brute Force
Sub-technique	T1110.003 — Password Spraying
Platform	Windows
Data Source	Windows Security Event Logs